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Report Name: RED III Implementation Hot Topic at Fuels of the Future 2026

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Report Highlights:

The upcoming national implementation of the renewable energy directive RED III, fraud prevention, ensuring a stable investment climate, and market conditions for biofuels and their feedstocks, were some of the core topics discussed at the 23rd international “Fuels of the Future” congress. In contrast to previous editions, the contribution of renewable fuels to energy security played a much larger role. This report highlights stakeholder comments expressed at the congress.



The 23rd edition of the annual, international “**Fuels of the Future**” congress was held on January 19-20, 2026, in Berlin under the theme “Turbocharge, Take Off with Renewables.”

The congress included a mixture of political and technical sessions. It was attended by over 620 participants and was organized by the following five associations from the German biofuels sector: the German Bioenergy Association (BBE), the Association for the Promotion of Oil and Protein Plants (UFOP), the Federal Association of the German Bioethanol Industry (BDBe), the German

Biofuel Industry Association (VDB), and the Professional Biogas Association (FvB). Further details and the conference program are available at www.fuels-of-the-future.com/en.

The event consisted of 15 sessions in which nearly 70 experts from the international biofuels sector; the mineral oil, automotive, and chemical industries; the mobility, logistics, and transport sector; scientists; and politicians presented strategies, concepts, and measures for climate neutral mobility, including in maritime shipping and aviation. They also discussed policy developments on the EU as well as the German national level, e.g., the upcoming transposition of the European Union (EU)’s renewable energy directive RED III into national law. The German Cabinet’s draft implementation law is up for discussion in the *Bundestag* (comparable to the U.S. House of Representatives). In this respect, the combat of fraud, the scope of national biofuels mandates, and thresholds for biomass-based fuels were key topics of discussion both in presentations and Q&A sessions alike.



The United States was prominently featured with Emily Marthaler from Growth Energy presenting on “The Modern U.S. Biorefinery as a Driver of Sustainable Innovation.”

Traditionally, the first day of the congress focuses more on the overall political framework while the second provides break-out sessions for biofuel-specific conversations and room for presentations on technical developments in the sector. This year topics included: electricity-based fuels (e-fuels); bioethanol, biomethane & bio- liquified natural gas (bio-LNG); renewable fuels for the maritime sector; sustainable aviation fuels; waste-based biofuels; green

hydrogen fuel; international renewable fuel trade; and fuel research.

The Following Themes Emerged During Multiple Presentations:

A Call on Policy Makers to Remain Technology Neutral

Several speakers agreed on the importance of e-mobility¹ but stressed that the current goals are not achievable without renewable fuels.

A Call for Realistic Goals and Higher Mandates in National RED implementation

Multiple speakers asked that goals should be realistic and achievable in the given time frame and should be reviewed if they are found to be overly ambitious (e.g., for sustainable aviation fuel.) At the same time, mandates should be high enough to ensure a large enough market for biofuels to keep them viable. Various speakers called for the national biofuel mandates to be increased and the cap in biomass-derived biofuels to be raised in order to keep demand stable. They argue this is necessary as multiple counting of other fulfillment options reduces room for actual consumption of biofuels.

A Call for Higher Biofuel Blending

Stakeholders noted that in light of shrinking diesel and gasoline consumption, the current blending limits of B7 and E10 should be increased to retain the GHG-reduction benefits of biofuels.

Need for Reliable Certification, Witness Audits, and Fraud Prevention

With reference to market distortions in the past two years caused by alleged fraudulently certified advanced biofuels, the audience welcomed a proposed abolition of double counting for these specific biofuels in Germany. However, speakers also called for mandatory witness audits in countries of origin to enhance fraud prevention.

The Importance of Biofuels for Energy Security

In the past, both in Germany and the EU, biofuel benefits were mostly seen in the context of greenhouse gas (GHG) emission reduction. Their contribution to energy security was largely neglected in the discussion. Against the backdrop of geopolitical conflicts, this aspect was mentioned a number of times this year, albeit still less than the importance of GHG reduction.

Key Statements from the Policy Session on Day 1

Marlene Mortler, chairwoman of the German Bioenergy Association (BBE), emphasized the role of renewable fuels to achieving climate targets: “Climate protection in transport can only be achieved with renewable fuels. They have an immediate effect, use existing infrastructure, and can be used in a variety of ways in the existing car fleet, heavy goods transport, aviation and shipping, as well as agriculture and forestry.”

¹ In this context, electric or e-mobility refers to the use of vehicles that are powered by electricity. It does not include the use of vehicles powered by a combustion engine that run on e-fuels (fuels generated with the use of electricity).

Patrick Schnieder, Federal Minister of Transport (BMV) presented the strategies and measures of the Federal Ministry of Transport for the expansion of renewable fuels in various transport sectors. He assured the audience that BMV is taking a technology-neutral approach in the sense that electro mobility should be pushed where feasible but renewable fuels have their role in those areas where electrification is difficult (e.g., aviation, maritime sector). Additionally, he deemed biofuels important as a “bridge-technology” until electricity-based fuels become available. With regard to national implementation of the RED III he called for the *Bundestag* to quickly approve the respective law.

Andreas Rade, Managing Director of Politics and Society at the German Association of the Automotive Industry (VDA), outlined the German automotive industry's path to climate-neutral mobility in his presentation: “Renewable fuels are an essential component in the defossilization of road transport. In addition to defossilizing the vehicle fleet, they are needed for the ramp-up of hydrogen mobility and vehicles that are proven to run exclusively on renewable fuels. To achieve this ramp-up, the existing potential and regulatory scope of biofuels must be strengthened.”

Karsten Schulze with the German Automotive Club (ADAC) shared that in a recent survey 66 percent of consumers supported the introduction of novel, climate-neutral fuels to reduce CO₂ emissions. ADAC promotes the transition to e-mobility and electricity-based fuels (E-fuels). However, E-fuels are not yet competitive and not available in sufficient quantities and market ramp-up would be necessary for economies of scale. As a conclusion, in the meantime he called to use all options in terms of transport and energy to achieve CO₂ reductions.

Conference Background:

“Fuels of the Future” is a two-day in-person event in Berlin. This year, the congress was attended by more than 620 participants from 30 countries and six continents.

The 24th Conference on Renewable Mobility “**Fuels of the Future 2027**” is scheduled for **January 18-19, 2027**, in Berlin. Further information is available at: www.fuels-of-the-future.com/en.

Attachments:

No Attachments.